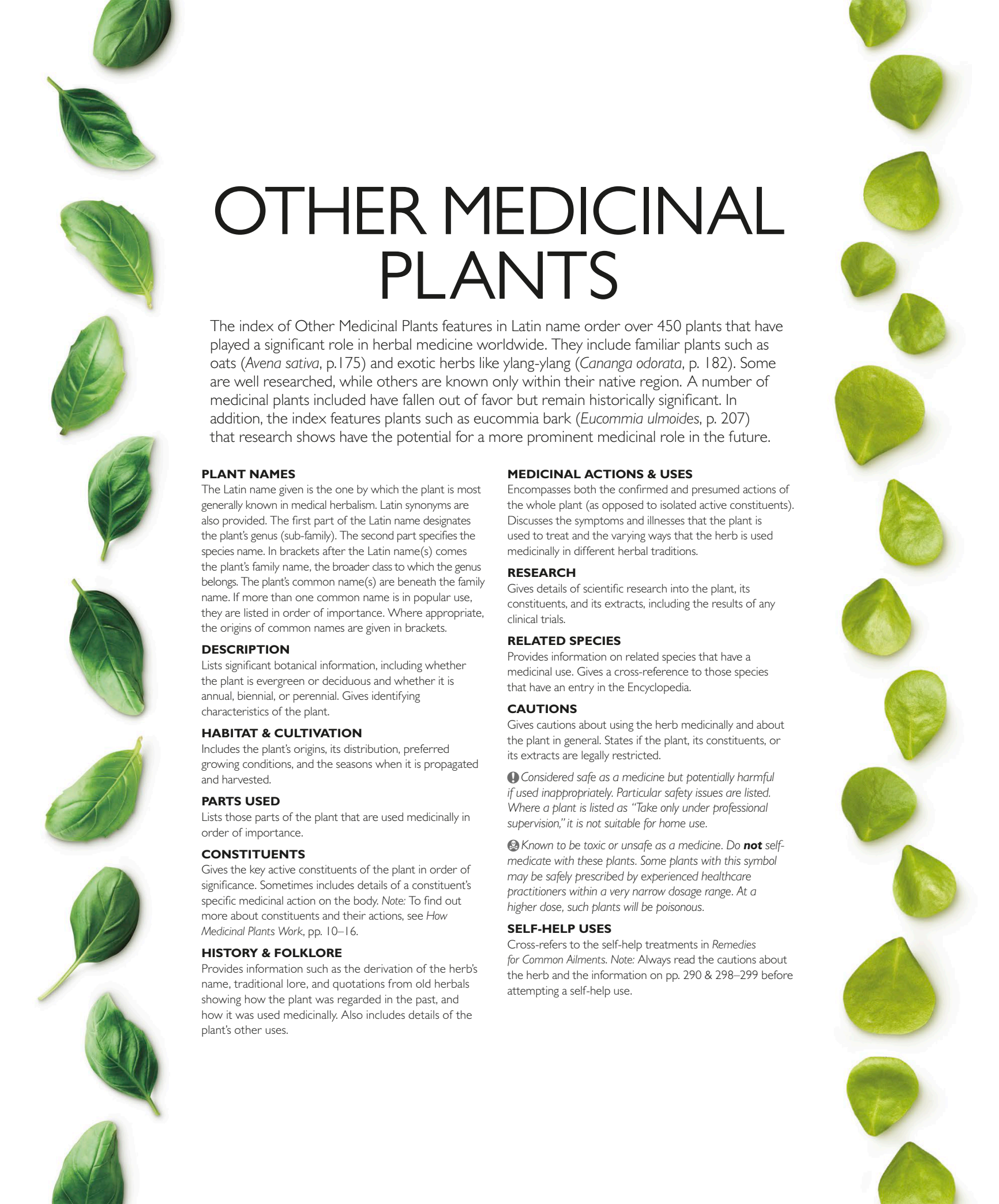




OTHER MEDICINAL PLANTS

The index of Other Medicinal Plants features in Latin name order over 450 plants that have played a significant role in herbal medicine worldwide. They include familiar plants such as oats (*Avena sativa*, p. 175) and exotic herbs like ylang-ylang (*Cananga odorata*, p. 182). Some are well researched, while others are known only within their native region. A number of medicinal plants included have fallen out of favor but remain historically significant. In addition, the index features plants such as eucommia bark (*Eucommia ulmoides*, p. 207) that research shows have the potential for a more prominent medicinal role in the future.

PLANT NAMES

The Latin name given is the one by which the plant is most generally known in medical herbalism. Latin synonyms are also provided. The first part of the Latin name designates the plant's genus (sub-family). The second part specifies the species name. In brackets after the Latin name(s) comes the plant's family name, the broader class to which the genus belongs. The plant's common name(s) are beneath the family name. If more than one common name is in popular use, they are listed in order of importance. Where appropriate, the origins of common names are given in brackets.

DESCRIPTION

Lists significant botanical information, including whether the plant is evergreen or deciduous and whether it is annual, biennial, or perennial. Gives identifying characteristics of the plant.

HABITAT & CULTIVATION

Includes the plant's origins, its distribution, preferred growing conditions, and the seasons when it is propagated and harvested.

PARTS USED

Lists those parts of the plant that are used medicinally in order of importance.

CONSTITUENTS

Gives the key active constituents of the plant in order of significance. Sometimes includes details of a constituent's specific medicinal action on the body. *Note:* To find out more about constituents and their actions, see *How Medicinal Plants Work*, pp. 10–16.

HISTORY & FOLKLORE

Provides information such as the derivation of the herb's name, traditional lore, and quotations from old herbals showing how the plant was regarded in the past, and how it was used medicinally. Also includes details of the plant's other uses.

MEDICINAL ACTIONS & USES

Encompasses both the confirmed and presumed actions of the whole plant (as opposed to isolated active constituents). Discusses the symptoms and illnesses that the plant is used to treat and the varying ways that the herb is used medicinally in different herbal traditions.

RESEARCH

Gives details of scientific research into the plant, its constituents, and its extracts, including the results of any clinical trials.

RELATED SPECIES

Provides information on related species that have a medicinal use. Gives a cross-reference to those species that have an entry in the Encyclopedia.

CAUTIONS

Gives cautions about using the herb medicinally and about the plant in general. States if the plant, its constituents, or its extracts are legally restricted.

⚠ *Considered safe as a medicine but potentially harmful if used inappropriately. Particular safety issues are listed. Where a plant is listed as "Take only under professional supervision," it is not suitable for home use.*

☠ *Known to be toxic or unsafe as a medicine. Do **not** self-medicate with these plants. Some plants with this symbol may be safely prescribed by experienced healthcare practitioners within a very narrow dosage range. At a higher dose, such plants will be poisonous.*

SELF-HELP USES

Cross-refers to the self-help treatments in *Remedies for Common Ailments*. *Note:* Always read the cautions about the herb and the information on pp. 290 & 298–299 before attempting a self-help use.